

HAOLIN (HAILEY) LI

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Introductory Computing Education, Equity and Accessibility in Computing Education, Software Engineering Education, Learning Sciences

EDUCATION

University of California, San Diego

Fall 2024 – Spring 2030

PhD in Computer Science. Incoming.

M.S. in Computer Science. GPA: 3.95/4.00

- Thesis: *A Qualitative Analysis of Debugging Processes and Teachings*. Advisor: Michael Coblenz

Wellesley College

Fall 2020 – Spring 2024

B.A. double major in Computer Science and Sociology, Magna Cum Laude. GPA: 3.82/4.00

- Capstone Project: *Droplet Duo: 2D Platformer Collaborative Game For All Ages*. Advisor: Jordan Tynes

RESEARCH EXPERIENCES

University of California, San Diego, SALAD Lab and CER Lab

Fall 2024 – Present

Thesis Student and Research Assistant. Advisor: Michael Coblenz; co-advisor: Leo Porter.

- SALAD Lab: worked with Prof. Michael Coblenz to conduct grounded theory analysis of debugging by 12 professional developers. Then, used the results to conduct a classroom study on how to teach debugging.
- CER Lab: participated in several computing education projects, including projects on human-centered computer science education, analysis of student process journals, and how novice students interact with vibe coding tools.

EdAI Project, MIT STEP Lab & Education Arcade

Summer 2022 – Spring 2024

Data Team and Curriculum Design Team Researcher, Field Investigator. Co-PIs: Irene Lee, Helen Zhang

- Studied how to teach middle school students AI literacy, specifically on how to train teachers.

Wellesley College, Department of Sociology

Fall 2023 – Spring 2024

Research Assistant. Advisor: Markella Rutherford

- Analyzed the social issues and educational focuses reflected through children's graphic novels.

PUBLICATIONS

- Li, McCurty, Singh, Waseem, Porter and Coblenz. **Student Perceptions and Use of Backward Tracing and Hypothesis Testing for Debugging in Software Engineering**. Submitted to the 26th Koli Calling International Conference on Computing Education Research (Koli Calling '26)
- Chao, Li, Ma, Nazzal, Kazerouni, Perlmutter and Soosai Raj, **Beyond the Final Code: Understanding Student Programming Behaviors through Process Journals**. Submitted to the 26th Koli Calling International Conference on Computing Education Research (Koli Calling '26)
- Li (2026). **Understanding and Teaching Debugging in Software Engineering: From Professional Practice to Student Learning**. *Master's thesis*.
- Soosai Raj, Kazerouni, Perlmutter, Chao, Li, Ma, Nazzal and Kallia (2026). **Human-Centered Process-Oriented Intro to Programming**. Submitted to the Technical Symposium on Computer Science Education (SIGCSE TS '27).
- Li & Coblenz (2026). **How Professional Software Engineers Debug: A Grounded Theory Analysis**. Proceedings of the 34th ACM Joint European Software Engineering Conference and Symposium on the Foundations of Software Engineering (ESEC/FSE '26) ([Link](#); [FSE26 Distinguished Paper Award](#))
- Geng, Shah, Li, Mulla, Swanson, Raj, Zingaro & Porter (2026). **Exploring Student-AI Interactions in Vibe Coding**. Proceedings of the 27th Australasian Computing Education Conference (ACE '26) ([Link](#))

- Moore, Zhang, Gupta, Kuhlken, Li & Lee (2023). **Online vs In-person Professional Learning Communities: A Qualitative Comparison of Teacher Learning Experiences**. Proceedings of the 16th International Conference on Computer-Supported Collaborative Learning (CSCL 2023). ([Link](#))

TEACHING EXPERIENCES

MIT Introduction to Technology, Engineering, and Science (MITES) Summer 2025
Computer Science Instructor; [[syllabus](#)]

- Taught a 7-week remote introduction to computer science class in Python to 18 high school senior students.

University of California, San Diego Fall 2024 – Winter 2026
Teaching Assistant serving more than 1500 students

- CSE 11 Intro to Programming and Computational Problem-Solving in Java: *Fall 2024 – Spring 2025*
- CSE 8A Intro to Programming in Python: *Summer 2025 – Winter 2026*

Wellesley College Fall 2022 – Spring 2024
Teaching Assistant

- CS 240 Fundamentals of Computer Systems (office hours, grading, recitations, instructional design): *Spring 2024*
- CS 230 Data Structures in Java (office hours, grading): *Fall 2022*
- MATH 225 Combinatorics and Graph Theory (grading): *Fall 2022*

GEC Tutoring Academy Teaching Assistant Summer 2024
Teaching Assistant

- Taught fundamental Python

Dearborn STEM Academy (Boston Urban Teaching Fellowship Program) Winter 2023
Assistant Teacher for 6th-11th Grades Urban Computer Science Class

- Observed and supported instruction in robotics, digital photography workflow, and senior projects.

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCES

Chicago Public Schools Information and Technology Services Summer 2024
Summer Associate, Project Management

- Established a software contract tracking dashboard with Google Suite to support the team procurement; contributed to strategic planning by talking to 30+ vendors and evaluated software products' functionalities and costs.

Hundsun Technologies Summer 2023
Java Full Stack Intern, FinTech

- Joined an Agile team of 9 to implement a carbon emissions trading system. Communicated on-site with clients to understand trading logic, identified design needs, and conducted process testing.

SERVICES AND LEADERSHIP

- Reviewer, Koli Calling International Conference on Computing Research. 2025 – 2026
- Mentor, Computing Research Association Undergraduate Research to PhD Mentoring program (UR2PHD). 2025
- Teaching Assistant Mentor, UC San Diego CSE599, CSE59. 2025
- Volunteer, ACM Technical Symposium on Computer Science Education (SIGCSE) 2025. 2025
- Volunteer, UWC Great Britain Selection Committee. 2023 – 2026
- Mentor, Wellesley College Computer Science Club. 2021 – 2024

SELECT AWARDS

- FSE 2026 Distinguished Paper Award. 2026.
- Travel scholarship for Conference on Programming Language Design and Implementation Programming Languages Mentorship Workshop (PLMW@PLDI). 2024
- Alpha Kappa Delta International Honor Society of Sociology. 2024
- Boston Urban Teaching Fellowship. 2023
- Davis-UWC Scholar. 2020